

45-Day Frontend Developer Plan (From Scratch)

HTML → CSS → JavaScript → React.js → Tailwind CSS

Assumes zero prior experience. Plan for 3-4 hours/day. Every day includes a small build so concepts stick.

PHASE 1: HTML & CSS (Days 1-10)

Day 1 — HTML Basics - Document structure, tags, headings, paragraphs, links, images, lists - Build: a simple "About Me" page

Day 2 — HTML Forms & Tables - Input types, forms, labels, buttons, tables - Build: a contact form page

Day 3 — HTML Semantic Tags - header, nav, main, section, article, aside, footer - Build: convert Day 1 page to use semantic structure

Day 4 — CSS Basics - Selectors, colors, fonts, box model (margin/border/padding) - Build: style the "About Me" page

Day 5 — CSS Positioning & Display - display (block/inline/inline-block), position (relative/absolute/fixed), z-index - Build: a simple card component with an image and badge

Day 6 — Flexbox - flex-direction, justify-content, align-items, flex-wrap, gap - Build: a responsive navbar using Flexbox

Day 7 — CSS Grid - grid-template-columns/rows, gap, grid areas - Build: a photo gallery layout using Grid

Day 8 — Responsive Design - Media queries, mobile-first approach, relative units (% , em, rem, vw/vh) - Build: make Day 6 navbar + Day 7 gallery responsive

Day 9 — CSS Extras - Transitions, transforms, simple animations, pseudo-classes (:hover, :nth-child) - Build: animated button and hover-effect cards

Day 10 — Project: Landing Page - Combine everything: HTML + CSS - Build: a full responsive landing page (navbar, hero, features section, footer)

PHASE 2: JavaScript (Days 11-20)

Day 11 — JS Basics - Variables (let/const), data types, operators, comments - Build: simple age/BMI calculator

Day 12 — Functions & Conditionals - Function declarations, arrow functions, if/else, switch - Build: a grading system (input score → output grade)

Day 13 — Arrays - Array basics, indexing, push/pop/splice, loops (for, forEach) - Build: a shopping list manager (console-based)

Day 14 — Array Methods - map, filter, reduce, find, some/every - Build: filter and total a list of products by price

Day 15 — Objects - Object literals, nested objects, dot vs bracket notation, Object.keys/values - Build: a simple contact book (array of objects)

Day 16 — DOM Manipulation - querySelector, getElementById, changing text/HTML/CSS via JS - Build: dark mode toggle button on a webpage

Day 17 — Events - addEventListener, event object, form submission handling - Build: a to-do list (add items, no persistence yet)

Day 18 — To-Do List (Full) - Combine DOM + events + arrays - Build: complete to-do app (add, delete, mark complete) in vanilla JS

Day 19 — ES6+ & Async Basics - Destructuring, spread/rest, template literals, promises basics - Build: refactor earlier projects using ES6+ syntax

Day 20 — Fetch API & JSON - fetch(), async/await, working with APIs, JSON.parse/stringify - Build: a weather app using a free public API

PHASE 3: React.js (Days 21-33)

Day 21 — React Introduction - What is React, Virtual DOM, setting up with Vite - JSX syntax rules - Build: static “Hello World” component tree (Header, Main, Footer)

Day 22 — Components & Props - Functional components, passing props, props.children - Build: a reusable Card component rendering a list of items

Day 23 — State with useState - useState hook, updating state, re-renders - Build: counter app with increment/decrement/reset

Day 24 — Event Handling & Conditional Rendering - onClick, onChange, ternaries, &&, conditional UI - Build: a like/unlike button + show/hide toggle component

Day 25 — Forms in React - Controlled inputs, handling multiple form fields - Build: a simple feedback form with validation messages

Day 26 — Lists & Keys - Rendering arrays with .map(), key prop importance - Build: render dynamic list of products/cards from an array

Day 27 — To-Do App in React - Combine state + forms + lists + events - Build: full React to-do app (add/delete/toggle complete)

Day 28 — useEffect Basics - useEffect for side effects, dependency array, cleanup functions - Build: a live search filter component

Day 29 — Fetching Data in React - useEffect + fetch/axios, loading and error states - Build: fetch and display data from a public API (e.g., users, posts)

Day 30 — Component Composition - Breaking apps into small reusable components, prop drilling awareness - Build: refactor Day 29’s project into clean components

Day 31 — React Router - BrowserRouter, Routes, Route, Link, useParams - Build: multi-page app (Home, About, Details page)

Day 32 — Context API - useContext for global state (e.g., theme or user auth) - Build: dark mode toggle using Context (app-wide)

Day 33 — Mini Project: Blog App - Combine routing + state + API fetch + components - Build: blog app — list of posts → click into post detail page

PHASE 4: Tailwind CSS (Days 34-38)

Day 34 — Tailwind Setup & Basics - Install Tailwind in your React (Vite) project - Utility classes: spacing, colors, typography, sizing - Build: restyle your Day 33 blog app's post list using Tailwind

Day 35 — Tailwind Layout - Flexbox/Grid utilities in Tailwind, responsive prefixes (sm:, md:, lg:) - Build: responsive navbar + card grid using Tailwind only

Day 36 — Tailwind States & Effects - hover:, focus:, transition utilities, dark mode support (dark:) - Build: interactive button set + a Tailwind-based form

Day 37 — Tailwind Components - Reusable styled components with Tailwind (buttons, modals, badges) - Build: a small component library (Button, Card, Modal, Badge)

Day 38 — Full Restyle - Apply Tailwind across your entire blog app project - Build: fully polished, responsive blog app UI

PHASE 5: Real Project & Wrap-Up (Days 39-45)

Day 39 — Plan Capstone Project - Choose one: E-commerce product listing, Task manager (Kanban-style), or Recipe/movie discovery app - Sketch pages, components, and data flow

Day 40 — Capstone: Setup & Layout - Scaffold project (Vite + React + Tailwind), build layout/navigation

Day 41 — Capstone: Core Features (Part 1) - Build main feature (listing, cards, main interactive functionality)

Day 42 — Capstone: Core Features (Part 2) - Add state management (useState/Context), forms if needed

Day 43 — Capstone: API Integration - Connect to a real or mock API (or Firebase/Supabase) for dynamic data

Day 44 — Capstone: Polish - Responsive design pass, loading/error states, small animations, bug fixes

Day 45 — Deploy & Wrap Up - Push to GitHub with a clean README - Deploy to Vercel or Netlify - Write a short case-study summary of what you built (great for resume/portfolio)

Tech Stack You'll Know by Day 45

- HTML5, CSS3 (Flexbox, Grid, responsive design)
- JavaScript (ES6+, DOM, fetch/async)
- React.js (hooks, routing, context, component patterns)
- Tailwind CSS
- Git/GitHub basics, deployment (Vercel/Netlify)

Tips

- Don't skip the small daily builds — they matter more than tutorials.
- Push every project to GitHub, even the small early ones.
- If a day's topic doesn't click, take an extra day on it before moving on — better to be solid than fast.
- After Day 45: learn TypeScript and consider Next.js — both are highly valued in real job listings.